STUDENT USER GUIDE

Learn only the task you need. You do not have to study Studio to use it.

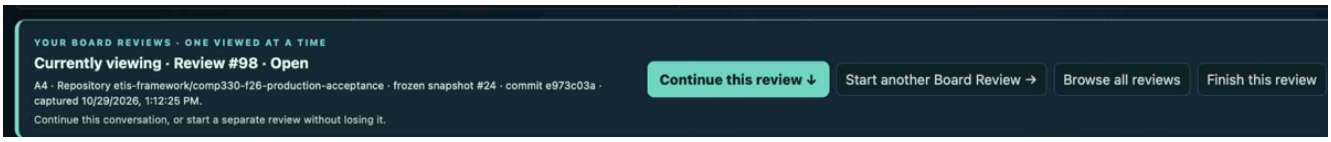
Start with a draft, not a finished assignment. The Review Board helps you think through engineering choices. You and your team own the decisions; your instructor owns formal acceptance.

Find what you need

I just signed in	**1 · Begin a review**
I want to ask a different question	2 · Have a conversation
I need to see what the Board checked	3 · Inspect evidence
I want to resume or start again	4 · Review history and snapshots
Something did not work	6 · Safe troubleshooting

The entire workflow in one line

Push a draft → Start Board Review → Talk → Inspect evidence when useful → Improve and push → Start another review.



An Open review highlights Continue this review. The same top bar also lets you start another review or browse history.

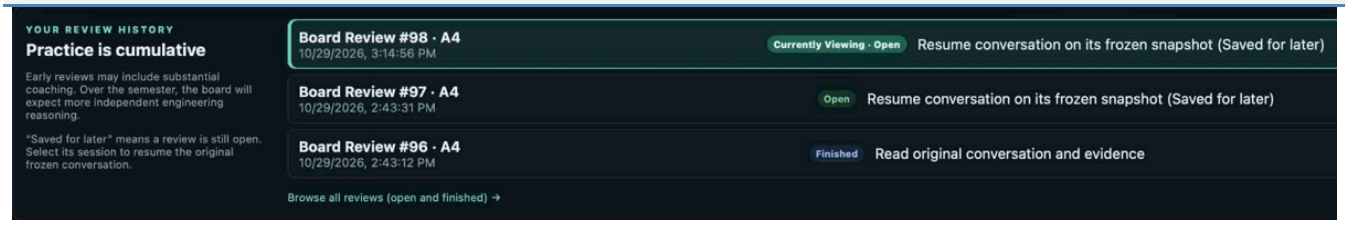
1 Begin a review

1. Sign in at simulator.etisframework.org using Loyola sign-in.
2. In My Team, check your course/team, link your own GitHub account, and look for Verified team repository. If already verified, do not repeat setup.
3. Commit and push the work you want discussed. Unpushed laptop files cannot be seen by Studio.
4. Open Engineering Review Room; confirm the phase (A1–A6).
5. Click the teal Start Board Review. That is the simplest default. If you want help with a particular artifact, choose Other review options → Focused Review.

Start early. A rough estimate, architecture sketch, risk table, or test plan is enough to ask for useful coaching.

Which kind of review?

Board Review	**You want the Board to choose an important issue in your current phase.**
Focused Review	You have a specific question, e.g. “Are our Cycle 1 estimates realistic?”
Review Findings	You want to discuss an issue Studio already flagged.



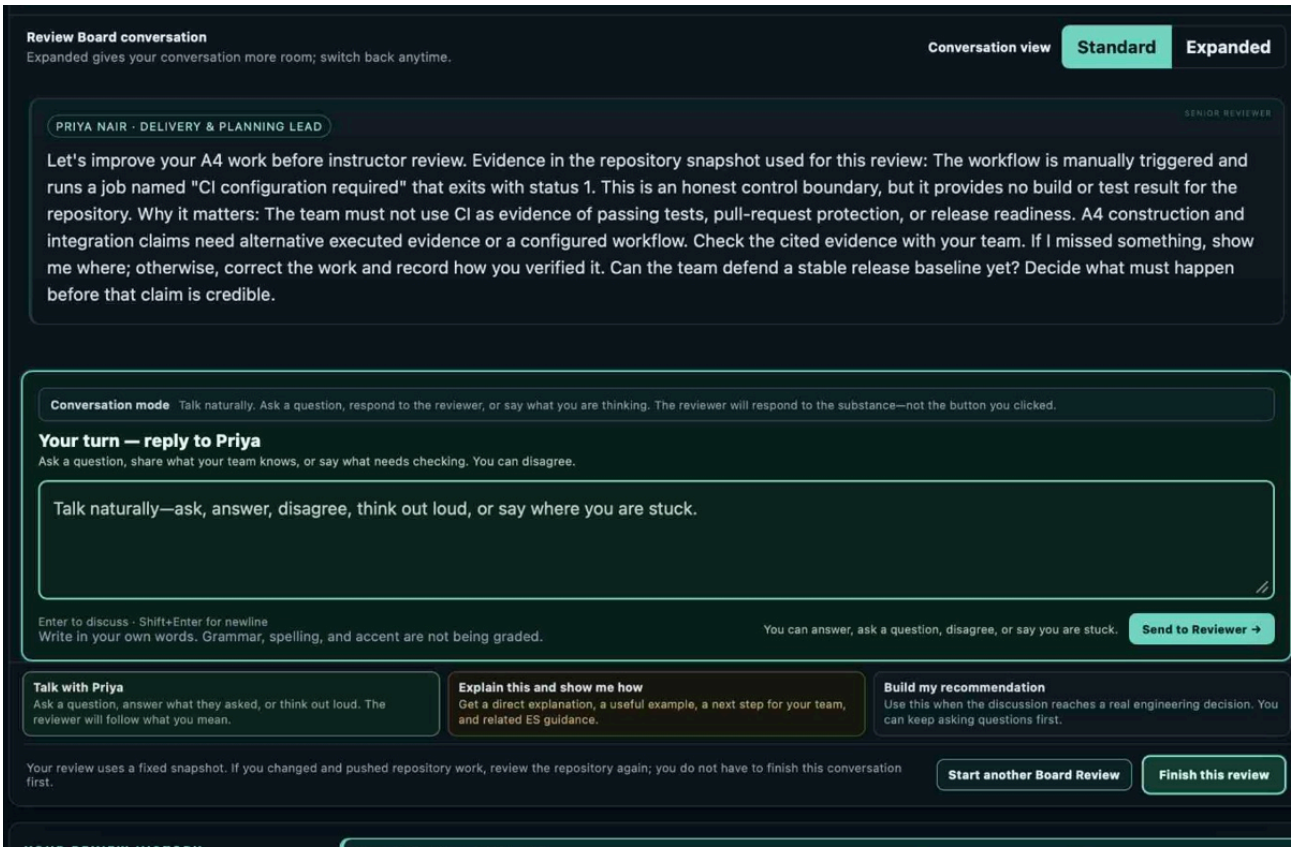
Review History keeps earlier Open and Finished sessions accessible.

2 Talk with the Board

It is a conversation, not a quiz. Respond in your own words. Your grammar and confidence are not what Studio grades—it does not grade you.

- Answer the reviewer's question, or change the subject: "Can we discuss our estimates first?"
- Ask for teaching: "Please show me a simple example."
- Challenge feedback: "We documented that in another file; can you inspect it?"
- Say you are uncertain: "I do not know yet; what evidence would help?"

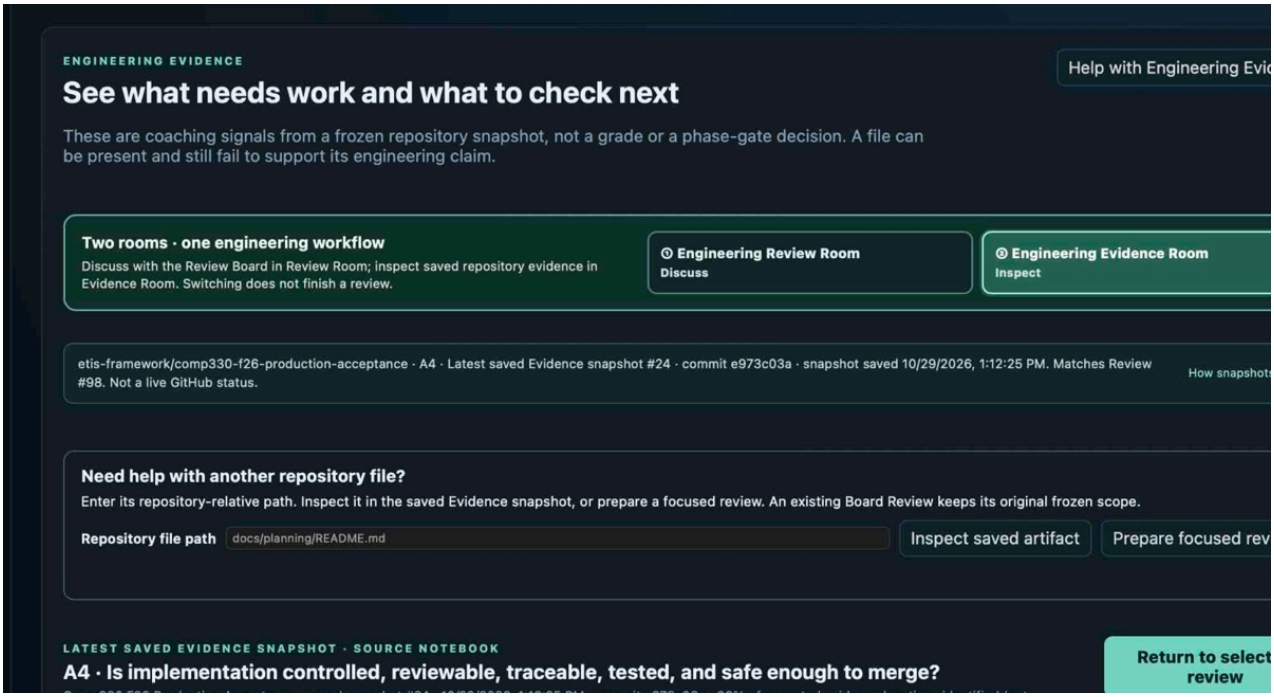
Choose Standard for the normal layout or Expanded for more room to read and write. Use Go to your reply when you have scrolled up through a long conversation. Do not send the same reply repeatedly while waiting.



The conversation area: read the question, type naturally, and send to the reviewer.

3 Inspect evidence only when you need it

Review Room = discussion. Evidence Room = saved files and concerns. You can move between the two without ending the conversation.



Engineering Evidence Room: look for a saved snapshot, a source file, or a concern. Return to selected review brings you back.

Choose the action that matches your question

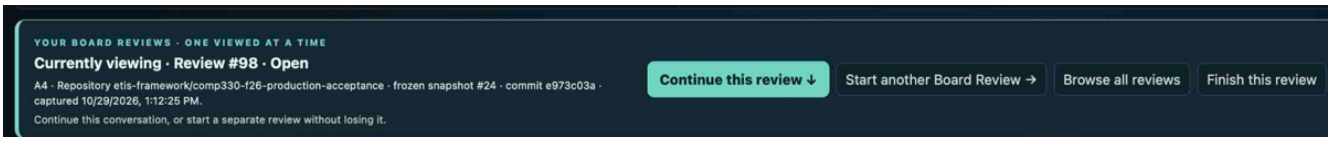
Inspect cited source	**Read the frozen file tied to the reviewer's concern.**
Find supporting evidence	Search for related or equivalent evidence inside the same saved snapshot.
Discuss / Challenge	Ask why the Board raised the concern or present a counterexample.
Help me resolve this	Ask for practical steps to make the engineering work stronger.
Inspect saved artifact	Look up a repository-relative path in the saved Evidence Room snapshot.
Prepare focused review	Start a separate focused conversation about a file; it does not change an older review.

If you do not see your file, verify its exact path and that it was committed before the snapshot. A missing result is not definitive proof the file does not exist in GitHub.

4 Continue, finish, or start another review

Continue an Open review

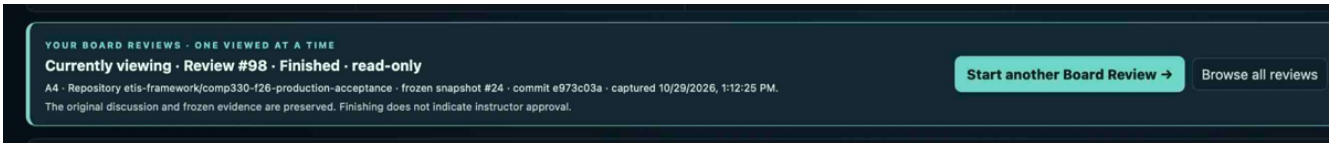
Click Continue this review, Go to your reply, or select an Open entry in Review History. Its discussion continues against the original frozen repository evidence, even after you push new commits.



Open review: continue the current conversation or start a separate one; multiple Open reviews are allowed.

Finish a review

Choose Finish this review when done. It remains in history but becomes read-only. Finishing does not indicate instructor approval.



Finished review: teal Start another Board Review directly prepares a new review—there is no second Start screen.

5 Review newer work without losing history

6. Improve the draft with your team. Run or inspect whatever tests and checks support your decision.
7. Commit and push to GitHub.
8. Click Start another Board Review. Studio prepares a separate conversation using the repository revision available at that time.
9. Check the snapshot/commit label. If the phase and commit are unchanged, Studio can reuse earlier evidence.
10. Use Browse all reviews to resume previous Open discussions or read Finished ones.

The important idea: new conversation ≠ necessarily new evidence. Old reviews never silently absorb later changes.

6 If something does not work

Review will not start	**Check My Team for your own GitHub link and the verified team repository. Check the selected phase. Look in history before retrying.**
I cannot type in this review	It may be Finished (read-only). Choose an Open review or start another.
The Board cites old work	Expected for an old review. Start another after pushing newer changes.
My draft answer is important	Copy critical unsent text before reloading or logging out; drafts may be browser-session specific.
I need help with a button	Use Help or Help & guidance. For an engineering question, ask the reviewer directly.
I think a finding is incorrect	Inspect the cited source, provide a path and reasoning, and challenge the interpretation.

What Studio does not do

- It does not submit your phase gate, replace Sakai requirements, or issue instructor approval.
- It does not prove tests passed merely because a CI file exists.
- It cannot rewrite a review's frozen evidence after later work is pushed.

If a problem persists, tell the instructor the phase, approximate time, action, and error. Do not share passwords, tokens, or private transcripts in public reports.